

Understand Your Gender Pay Gap

3-page practical pamphlet for employers

Use your gender pay gap data to identify where imbalance appears, why it happens, and what to change first.

What this pamphlet covers

Diagnosis

Pay levels, promotions, recruitment, exits, and variable pay.

Progression risks

Starting salaries, performance scoring, part-time access.

Culture factors

Caring responsibilities and flexibility uptake by gender.

Delivery

Action plan template with owners, deadlines, and metrics.

Quick start

- Collect baseline data for women and men across grades/roles.
- Check where representation changes most through each process.
- Prioritise 3–5 root causes, then define measurable actions.

Tip: Review results monthly or quarterly to see whether actions are reducing your gap.

Core analysis checks

1) Pay levels (pay quarters)

- Compare women/men in upper, upper-middle, lower-middle, and lower quarters.
- Break down by team, occupation, and grade.

2) Promotions

- Track gender split at application, shortlist, and selection stages.
- Identify stages where women's representation drops.

3) Recruitment by seniority

- Compare outcomes across application → shortlist → selection → acceptance.
- Check if women are overrepresented in lower-paid hiring.

4) Exit rates

- Compare annual exits by gender and grade.
- Focus on higher-paid grades where exits can widen the gap faster.

5) Bonuses, overtime, other pay

- For comparable work, compare eligibility, participation, and average value.

6) Starting salaries

- Compare starting pay for similar roles; test negotiation impact.

7) Performance scores

- Compare by gender, grade, and role; separate self vs manager ratings if possible.

8) Part-time progression

- Compare progression and performance between part-time and full-time staff.

9) Caring responsibilities & culture

- Compare take-up of flexible working, Shared Parental Leave, and paternity leave.

Checklist + action plan template

A) Snapshot table

Indicator	Women %	Men %	Gap / note
Upper pay quarter			
Promotion selected			
Senior hires			
Senior exits			
Bonus recipients			
Flexible working take-up			

B) Top causes (3–5)

Cause identified	Evidence	Affected group/grade

C) Action plan

Issue	Action	Owner	Deadline	Success metric

D) Review rhythm

- Review frequency: Monthly / Quarterly
- Next review date: _____
- Owner accountable for reporting: _____

Final step: publish progress transparently and iterate actions based on what the data shows.